

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Group Director of Internal Audit & GRC

Dubai, UAE (Golden Visa) | +971 507 471 708
majidrajpar@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Portfolio](#)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Group Director of Internal Audit and GRC with over 20 years of experience, including 15 years across the GCC, with a career built inside operational businesses: a USD 1.5B cloud kitchen platform, a multi-sector conglomerate spanning F&B, FMCG, retail, and healthcare, and advisory engagements across QSR, real estate, and hospitality operators. Trusted advisor to Boards and Audit Committees, known for deploying AI-enabled monitoring that moves audit coverage from statistical sampling to full-population assurance, and for closing the gap between governance frameworks and the operational realities non-financial businesses face.

This work has recovered AED 7.7M in revenue leakage, identified SAR 4M in procurement irregularities through forensic analysis, and neutralized SAR 15M in hidden M&A risk; consistently repositioning internal audit as a commercial risk intelligence function rather than a compliance cost centre.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Veritux Consulting Network

Senior Advisor, Internal Audit & Risk

Dubai, UAE

Jul 2025 – May 2026

- **GCC Advisory Practice:** Built an independent advisory practice; engagements spanned fraud risk policy reviews for a regional QSR operator, internal audit charter and manual development for a UAE property developer, and an internal audit diagnostic for a GCC F&B group covering governance structure, methodology, and reporting effectiveness.
- **Forensic Audit & ML Analysis:** Applied ML-enabled forensic analysis to a KSA real estate developer's project portfolio; identified SAR 4M in procurement irregularities across two project reviews, at a detection depth conventional audit sampling could not achieve.

Kitopi

Cloud Kitchen Technology Platform | Peak Valuation: USD 1.5B

Director of GRC & Internal Audit

Dubai, UAE

Jun 2022 – May 2025

- **Function Leadership:** Built and led the GRC and internal audit function from the ground up; structured a team of 5 (including 1 manager) covering operational risk, IT governance, ethics, and special investigations; designed and executed the risk-based annual audit plan, presenting it to the Audit Committee within three months of joining.
- **Operational Risk Assurance:** Designed the audit assurance strategy; leveraged ML anomaly detection and Deep Learning OCR to achieve full-population invoice coverage during a 340% surge in transaction volume; reduced fraud incidents by 78%, with programme outcomes and fraud metrics presented to the Audit Committee on a quarterly basis.
- **IT Governance & Cybersecurity Assurance:** Designed the ITGC framework for a rapidly scaling cloud platform; directed group-wide cybersecurity assessments and penetration testing that identified critical exposures, leading to the selection of a managed security contractor and a remediation programme that closed all identified material vulnerabilities.
- **Digital Governance:** Directed audit oversight of the Group's G-Suite to Microsoft 365 migration; independent validation confirmed full data integrity: zero data loss or integrity issues across the migration.
- **IPO Governance Readiness:** Established the ICFR programme from scratch for the pre-IPO roadmap; EY's external readiness attestation confirmed zero material weaknesses and zero significant deficiencies.

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- **Ethics Programme & Whistleblowing:** Owned the Group's ethics and whistleblowing programme end-to-end: led competitive selection of NAVEX EthicsPoint, designed the case management framework and escalation protocol, and reported case status directly to the Audit Committee; the programme established a functioning speak-up culture with genuine organisational reach; case management, escalation, and remediation were tracked independently through to Audit Committee reporting.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple sensitive internal investigations, including a CAPEX governance breach inquiry; 95% of findings were substantiated and 99% of management actions closed, with each case managed from design through evidence handling to Audit Committee reporting, independent of management.
- **Commercial Integrity Monitoring:** Recovered AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralized AED 4.5M in future exposure through automated, continuous monitoring.
- **Audit Transformation:** Directed the build-out of a continuous transaction monitoring capability across seven audit domains, covering flagging logic, workflow routing, and exception reporting; shifted the function from periodic reviews to ongoing real-time monitoring; maintained management action tracking through to closure, with overdue items escalated directly to the Audit Committee.

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC)

Riyadh, KSA

Diversified Conglomerate: F&B, FMCG, Retail, Healthcare & Pharma

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk

Nov 2016 – May 2022

- **M&A Due Diligence:** Led internal due diligence on a \$127M acquisition, identifying SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure; findings were used to renegotiate terms before closing.
- **Function Professionalization:** Grew the internal audit team from 3 to 20 professionals, managing the department budget and resource allocation across a five-sector portfolio; achieved the IIA 'Generally Conforms' rating on external quality assessment.
- **Enterprise Risk Management (ERM):** Built a Board-commissioned ERM framework consolidating risk exposure across five sectors; framework directly informed an insurance strategy overhaul at SAFI Danone that reduced premiums by approximately 15%, and underpinned revised Board and committee charters, adopted by the holding company's Audit Committee, through which portfolio risks were measured against the Group's stated risk appetite.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple special investigations across the Group's portfolio covering procurement irregularities, supplier conduct, and related-party concerns; each case managed from forensic intake to Audit Committee reporting and remediation tracking, independent of management; sustaining a 95% substantiation rate and 99% action closure rate across the portfolio.
- **Cybersecurity Vendor Governance:** Led the competitive selection and onboarding of AT&T as Group MSSP, consolidating fragmented in-house security coverage into 24/7 managed threat monitoring across all Group entities.
- **Financial Controls (ICFR):** Designed and implemented the ICFR programme for the Group's F&B subsidiary, establishing its first structured financial reporting control environment; the programme passed EY's external audit with no major control deficiencies identified.
- **Fraud Prevention & Detection:** Generated SAR 4.2M in annual savings through predictive ML-enabled monitoring of procurement and supplier payment processes.

EARLIER CAREER & BIG 4 FOUNDATION

Manager, Internal Audit McDonald's Saudi Arabia	2014 – 2016
Internal Audit Manager KPMG (Qatar)	2011 – 2013
AVP, Internal Audit BMA Asset Management	2010 – 2011
Audit Manager Ernst & Young (Karachi, Pakistan)	2004 – 2009

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing, *GRC Report*
- Keeping Risk Registers Relevant, *ACCA AB Magazine*
- FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances About How Bribery Works in the Persian Gulf, *Corporate Compliance Insights*
- Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags, *IIA Internal Auditor Magazine (Voices)*
- AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability, *GRC Report*
- The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy: When AI Models Age Faster Than Evolving Fraud, *Consultancy ME*

EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & EXPERTISE

- **Core Credentials:** CIA, ACA, FCCA
- **Degree:** B.Com (Karachi University)
- *ACCA qualification: UK Master's degree equivalent (UK ENIC)*

Governance & Audit Frameworks: IIA Standards | COSO ERM & ISO 31000 | ICFR / SOX | COBIT | ISO 27001 | NIST CSF | Third-Party Risk | Forensic Investigations | Cyber-security Assurance

Audit Technology: AI/ML-enabled continuous monitoring | Deep Learning OCR | Python-based automation | NAVEX EthicsPoint | ITGC & Cloud Governance | SAP | Oracle | O365/G-Suite

Executive Certifications:

- Certificate in Disruptive Strategy (Harvard Business School)
- Enterprise Risk Management Certificate (COSO)
- Information Systems Auditing & IT Governance (HKUST)
- Machine Learning with Python (IBM)
- Forensic Accounting and Fraud Examination (WVU)
- Risk Management Specialization (NYIF)